

PHONE QUESTIONS TO ASK FORMER LANDLORD(S)

One of your current or former residents has applied to rent a property that I manage. The resident has given me your name and permission to ask if you could please verify a few quick things regarding his rental with you. This would be a big help to him or her. May I?

1. Can you verify that if the resident is or was paying you \$_____ per month in rent?
Please note: Ask the former landlord to verify an amount that is actually different (by \$50 or \$100) than the amount stated by the applicant on the rental application. The purpose of this initial question is to see very quickly if you are dealing with a landlord who will be honest with you and who is not just trying to get rid of a resident. If the landlord does not correct you about the amount of rent paid, you know that you either have a land lord willing to lie to you or a friend just pretending to be the landlord. No need to ask further questions. Just simply say, "Thank you; you've been very helpful."
2. How many weeks advance notice has the resident given you that he or she is moving?
3. Is the resident currently up-to-date with his or her payments?
4. Has the resident been late once or more than once during the last 12 months?
5. Has the resident ever been late more than 30 days?
6. How many months/years did the resident reside in your property?
7. Is the resident vacating early, before the full term or end of his agreement?
8. Did you receive any complaints of any kind from neighbors regarding the resident?
9. How many people occupied the residence?
- 10).Were there any noise or complaints?
- 11).Were there any police calls at the residence that you were aware of?
- 12). How much notice to the resident give you that he or she was moving? Or did the residents give proper notice to vacate?
13. How many pets did the resident have on the premises? Had the animal(s) lived there with your permission?
14. Were there any complaints from the neighbors regarding pets or animals?
15. Have you had to give a notice to the resident for any reason during the last 12 months because of a rental violation? If so, what rental violation was the notice for?
16. Was the resident asked to move because of nonpayment or for breaking one of the lease terms? Or is he or she moving voluntarily?
17. Did or will you have to withhold any deposit to cover any unpaid rent or damages?
18. Did or will you have to repaint or clean the carpets after the resident vacates?

Thank you very much for your assistance.

Please note that these were all objective questions, wherein the answers could be easily documented. Do not put other landlords in a position where you are seeking subjective answers that cannot be easily documented or de fended (e.g., what kind of residents were they? Or was he or she a good resident?).

LANDLORD VERIFICATION

From: _____, prospective resident

Re: _____, address

Date _____

To: _____, current/former landlord

I authorize you to give the requested information below to my prospective landlord:

Signed _____

Date: _____

Dear Sir or Madam:

_____ has applied
to rent one of our rentals and has given your name as present or former landlord.

To verify the information he or she has given to us on the rental application can you
please supply us with the needed information below? I have enclosed a self-addressed
envelope for your convenience.

Thank you for your cooperation.

Sincerely,

Rental Manager

The applicant rented from you from when to when? _____

Rent Amount \$ _____ Always pay on time? _____

Payment record: Excellent _____ Fair _____ Poor _____

Did or will he/she receive full security deposit back? _____

If not, why not? _____

Did applicant break any rental violations or do damage? _____

Did you ever had to place notice to fill out court summons? _____

Evicted (Why) _____